CELPIP EXPRESS

Reading Test

STUDY MATERIALS - 15

Conteúdo licenciado para Arezoo -

PART 1

Read the following message.

Dear Mrs. Johnson,

Please accept my application for the position of sales clerk in your department store, as advertised on your website. I have had the pleasure of reviewing your company's website and am very enthusiastic about the position advertised. I believe that my skills and abilities make me the perfect candidate for this position, and I would be an asset to your sales team.

With four years of experience selling footwear, and having worked for two years in a women's clothing store at a local mall, I have developed effective customer service techniques. I enjoy working with the public, assisting shoppers by inquiring about their needs, and suggesting suitable products to meet their tastes and budget. The management team in the clothing store where I worked recognized my strong customer service skills by choosing me as 'Employee of the Month' on more than one occasion. I completed a customer service course at a local college, and attended additional training offered by my employer.

As a sales associate, not only did I assist customers, but I also handled cash, credit card, and debit transactions. I processed returns, as well as performed opening and closing procedures in the store. These responsibilities show the level of trust that my employers put in me and my abilities. Finally, the store environment required that the staff work as part of a team, which is one of my strengths. I am also comfortable working on my own. Other important skills I gained in that role include completing sales reports, meeting sales targets, and ordering stock.

Please find attached a resume outlining my retail experience, skills, and training. I feel that these qualifications equip me to make a valuable contribution to your retail establishment. I would appreciate the opportunity to discuss the position with you. I will contact you in ten days time to answer any questions you may have and to see if you need any other information from me. Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,

Brenda Ashburn

Choose the **best** option according to the information given in the message.

1. Brenda wrote Mrs. Johnson a _____
- ◯ reference letter.
- ◯ letter of request.
- ◯ letter of complaint.
- ◯ cover letter.

2. Mrs. Johnson and Brenda are _____
- ◯ employer and job seeker.
- ◯ employee and client.
- ◯ manager and employee.
- ◯ employee and sales rep.

3. Brenda is responding to _____
- ◯ a letter from a co-worker.
- ◯ a memo from an employment centre.
- ◯ a job advertisement.
- ◯ a personal ad.

4. Brenda has shown she is good at _____
- ◯ management.
- ◯ customer service.
- ◯ training others.
- ◯ making a budget.

5. By working in retail, Brenda learned how to _____
- ◯ trust others.
- ◯ work as part of a team.
- ◯ write cheques.
- ◯ run sales meetings.

6. Because of her skills, experience, and training, Brenda will probably _____
- ◯ hire Mrs. Johnson.
- ◯ be called for an interview.
- ◯ get a promotion.
- ◯ become 'Employee of the Month.'

Conteúdo licenciado para Arezoo -

PART 1

Here is a response to the message. Complete the response by filling in the blanks.

Dear Ms. Ashburn,

Thank you for your application and interest in our company. I am glad to hear that you are 7. _____ working at our store.

You mentioned that you worked in a 8. _____ and a women's clothing store. However, 9. _____ in the housewares department. Do you have any experience in this area? We do offer some training, but it's limited.

Your experience helping customers by 10. _____ and staying within their price range is exactly what we are looking for. The fact that you have experience 11. _____ makes you a suitable candidate for the position, as this job requires a large volume of sales.

I would like to meet with you to discuss your resume and your skills. My assistant will be in touch in the next couple of days to schedule a meeting.

Sincerely,

Mrs. Johnson

7. ◯ happy to be
   ◯ not tired of
   ◯ sure about
   ◯ excited about

8. ◯ sports store
   ◯ boutique
   ◯ shoe store
   ◯ call centre

9. ◯ the position is for a manager
   ◯ we are not hiring anyone
   ◯ the opening we have is
   ◯ the manager has experience

10. ◯ targeting their needs
    ◯ finding someone to help them
    ◯ selling them expensive items
    ◯ giving them a discount

11. ◯ winning awards
    ◯ processing purchases
    ◯ training staff
    ◯ opening the store

Conteúdo licenciado para Arezoo -

PART 2

Cloverford Recreation Centre

Drop-In Group Fitness Classes

Extreme Bootcamp

An advanced level workout that increases stamina, strength, and flexibility using a variety of fitness and athletic conditioning drills.

Days: Tuesday, Thursday
Time: 7:30-8:30 AM
Ages: 18+
Fee: $5 per session or FREE for members

Circuit Weight Training

Move through the weight room and learn to use the strength machines, free weights, and cardio equipment.

Days: Monday, Wednesday
Time: 8:00 PM to 9:15 PM
Ages: 13+ (under 16 must be accompanied by an adult)
Fee: $4 per class or FREE for members

Beginner Spin Class

Cycling workout that features a variety of drills including hills, sprints, and intervals on a non-impact, indoor stationary bicycle.

Days: Friday
Time: 5:15 PM to 6:00 PM
Ages: 16+
Fee: $5 per class or FREE for members

Intermediate Pilates

A body conditioning routine which emphasizes spinal alignment and breathing. A great workout for developing a strong core and improving coordination and balance.

Days: Wednesday, Friday
Time: 10:45 to 11:45 AM
Ages: 18+
Fee: $8 per class or FREE for members

Yoga – Adults Only

Develop your flexibility and strength through the completion of a combination of postures and breathing exercises.

Days: Monday, Wednesday, Thursday
Time: 6:30PM to 8:00PM
Ages: 19+
Fee: $8 per class or FREE for members

Enjoy the benefits of membership!

Become a Member at the Cloverford Recreation Centre and receive unlimited access to our facilities and group classes.

Rates start at **$19.99** per month for individuals and **$69.99** for families.

Read the following email message about the diagram on the left. Complete the email by filling in the blanks

Subject: Are you free for lunch?
To: Anna Smith <ansmith@dunderson.com>
From: Jeanette LeBlanc <jeanb@ses.com>

Hi Anna,

Remember how you mentioned wanting to be more active? Well, I got this flyer in the mail for the recreation centre near our office and thought you might be interested in 1. _____ . I'd only be available evenings though. Since changing departments, I'm at my desk by 7:00 a.m. every day (I miss getting picked up on your way to work!).
As far as classes go, I'm hoping to get in shape before summer, meaning I'd like to go as many nights a week as possible. So my preference would be the 2. _____. Actually, I'm trying to convince my entire family to do the same. However, this place might not be the best for them since 3. _____ . Anyways, I know you had mentioned wanting to try a bootcamp class, but, unfortunately, it isn't 4. _____ . Hopefully one of the other classes will work.
Also, if we were to buy the monthly membership 5. _____ . Definitely worth considering!
Let me know!!

Jeanette

1. ◯ signing up for a drop-in class
   ◯ trying out a weekend fitness class
   ◯ registering for a free trial class
   ◯ joining their team sports league

2. ◯ Beginner Spin Class
   ◯ Circuit Weight Training
   ◯ Intermediate Pilates
   ◯ Yoga for Adults

3. ◯ children must be over 16
   ◯ most classes are for women
   ◯ there isn't a family rate
   ◯ most classes are for adults

4. ◯ a drop-in class
   ◯ meant for beginners
   ◯ a challenging workout
   ◯ intended for adults

5. ◯ our husbands get free memberships
   ◯ we get a reduced rate on classes
   ◯ our first month of classes are free
   ◯ we can attend any class for free

Conteúdo licenciado para Arezoo -

PART 2

Choose the best option.

6. What is Jeanette's relationship to Anna?

- client
- friend
- boss
- neighbour

7. Why does Jeanette want to take evening classes?

- She works in the morning.
- She can get a ride with Anna.
- She wants to avoid getting up early.
- She prefers the classes being offered.

8. What does Jeanette think about the membership?

- The family membership would be best.
- It's a great value for the money.
- The trial membership is a good price.
- It's not as good as drop-in classes.

Conteúdo licenciado para Arezoo -

PART 3

Read the following passage.

A. In this age of global connectedness and social networking, it is hard to imagine that lost tribes still exist. However, the Sentinelese tribe of the Andaman Islands are just that. This indigenous group has been living on North Sentinel Island in the Indian Ocean's Bay of Bengal for thousands of years. Living on a sea route that has been travelled since ancient times, the Sentinelese have impressively managed to avoid influence from outside civilizations. They are the last tribe of the Andaman Islands to maintain their isolation, mainly because of their hostile resistance to outsiders' attempts at contact.

B. Due to lack of access, little is known about the Sentinelese people. What knowledge exists comes either from observation from a distance or is based on comparison with other Andaman tribes. A hunter-gatherer society, the Sentinelese subsist mainly by hunting, fishing, and collecting wild plants, and do not appear to have developed any agricultural practices. The majority of their tools and weapons are made from stone and animal bones; however, there is some evidence that they make use of metal fragments that wash ashore. They use javelins and flatbows as weapons, in addition to a variety of arrows. Canoes, nets, and harpoons serve as fishing gear.

C. Because contact with the Sentinelese tribe is nearly impossible, it is difficult to estimate the size of their population. Based on a limited number of encounters by outsiders and attempts by census officials to infer numbers by counting from a distance, it is estimated that there could be anywhere between 20 and 60 individuals. The island's inhabitants tend to live in two types of dwellings. There are shelter-style huts that can house a group of three or four people. These huts have no walls, and their floors are covered in palm leaves. Additionally, there are more elaborate communal huts with raised floors and specific areas for fire.

D. Starting in 1967, attempts at peaceful contact were made by the Indian government with the support of anthropologists. During these contact expeditions, gifts of coconuts were left on the shore on several occasions in an effort to diminish the aggressiveness the Sentinelese demonstrated toward strangers. The Indian authorities had limited success before finally discontinuing the expeditions out of concern for the tribe. Due to their isolation from the outside world, it was decided that contact with the tribe only put them at risk of contracting diseases. Since then, the government policy has been to leave the tribe alone.

E. Not given in any of the above paragraphs.

Decide which paragraph, A to D, has the information given in each statement below.

Select E if the information is not given in any of the paragraphs.

1. Sentinelese isolation is surprising because travellers have long known about their island.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

2. The Indian government used to leave food offerings for the Sentinelese.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

3. The government is passing a bill to protect the Sentinelese community from modern diseases.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

4. Census data on the Sentinelese have been collected by indirect observation.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

5. The Indian government stopped visiting the Sentinelese for fear of contagion.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

6. The Sentinelese aggressively reject any outside technology that washes ashore.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

7. Food production on North Sentinel Island has remained very basic.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

8. The floors in Sentinelese huts may be elevated or covered with foliage.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

9. The Sentinelese are the last remaining tribe on the Andaman Islands.

○ A ○ B ○ C ○ D ○ E

Conteúdo licenciado para Arezoo -

PART 4

Read the following article from a website.

When a small town loses a major employer, the impact is enormous. Consider a community of about 20,000 people where 1,200 are employed at one business that suddenly lays off half of its employees. This happened recently at a Nova Scotia factory, Queenston Paper. The 600 dismissed employees were offered relocation, early retirement, or severance packages. One hundred fifty of the previous employees opted to relocate to another Queenston Paper factory in Nova Scotia. About 200, primarily those having built up a large enough pension, are considering retirement. Many others will receive a severance package of more than half their annual earnings. However, many feel this has little appeal since government taxes will take at least 40 percent. The rest have yet to choose their future.

Janice Witherspoon says that she and her husband wanted to enjoy their attractive Queenston salaries for five more years. Feeling secure in working at the 50-year-old factory and with their seniority status, they have been spending instead of saving. Moving isn't an option, she says. Real estate prices are far higher at the other Queenston Paper town, so the Witherspoons would end up in debt again. She scoffed at the ridiculous severance package. "Three choices", she says, "but not one is really viable for us at this time of life."

Ginny Rousseau is more optimistic. An immigrant from France, Ginny loves the area. She and her family intend to stay. "It doesn't cost a lot to live here," she says, "so we're going for early retirement. We're already doing a little farming, a little gardening, and trying to be self-sustainable. It's very rewarding." Like Ginny, many Queenston Paper employees are not native to Canada, but they don't all share her complacency. Without jobs, these relative newcomers have no reason to remain. Quite a few have packed their bags and headed west in search of work. "It's unfortunate", says David Santos, a Brazilian. "With the low cost of rent, I have managed to save a lot. I had hoped to eventually save enough to bring my family over from Brazil. This would have been a great place for my kids to grow up. Without work though, there is no point in sticking around."

Choose the **best** option according to the information given on the website.

1. Which option is least attractive to the laid-off employees?

- ◯ early retirement
- ◯ moving reimbursement
- ◯ relocation
- ◯ severance package

2. What do David and Ginny have in common?

- ◯ outlooks
- ◯ backgrounds
- ◯ savings
- ◯ goals

3. David would agree with Janice that _____

- ◯ layoffs should be based on seniority.
- ◯ housing is affordable in their town.
- ◯ relocation is the best choice.
- ◯ retirement is an attractive option.

4. Why are some of the laid-off employees moving away?

- ◯ Getting into farming is easier elsewhere.
- ◯ They do not feel welcome in the community.
- ◯ They took jobs at another manufacturing plant.
- ◯ Industry salaries are higher in Western Canada.

5. Ginny and David would agree that _____

- ◯ Farming is becoming more common in the area.
- ◯ The town is a pleasant place to settle down.
- ◯ People need to go where the jobs are.
- ◯ It is difficult for newcomers to find work.

Conteúdo licenciado para Arezoo -

PART 4

The following is a comment by a visitor to the website page. Complete the comment by choosing the best option to fill in each blank.

It mystifies me why those laid off complain about their situation. Jobs come and go; our town is not unique. In my opinion, these people were lucky to get such generous layoff options. When I was laid off several years ago, I was certainly not offered 6. _____ . Also, why would anyone be upset about having to 7. _____ ? These charges are standard, so it shouldn't be surprising to see them taken from a 8. _____ agreement. Furthermore, the tax credit you get when you move closer to your job would pay for the difference in 9. _____ between the one town and the other Queenston Paper location. I agree with 10. _____ , one needs to look on the bright side of the situation.

6. ◯ 40% of my annual salary
   ◯ the opportunity to work elsewhere
   ◯ continued pension contributions
   ◯ financial help to move

7. ◯ pay income taxes
   ◯ contribute to their pension
   ◯ cover their moving costs
   ◯ dip into their savings

8. ◯ layoff
   ◯ relocation
   ◯ retirement
   ◯ severance

9. ◯ commuting costs
   ◯ accommodation costs
   ◯ government taxes
   ◯ salaries

10. ◯ Queenston
    ◯ Santos
    ◯ Rousseau
    ◯ Witherspoon

Conteúdo licenciado para Arezoo -

Answer Key

PART 1	
Question 1	cover letter.
Question 2	employer and job seeker.
Question 3	a job advertisement.
Question 4	customer service.
Question 5	work as part of a team.
Question 6	be called for an interview.
Question 7	excited about
Question 8	shoe store
Question 9	the opening we have is
Question 10	targeting their needs
Question 11	processing purchases

PART 2	
Question 1	signing up for a drop-in class
Question 2	Yoga for Adults
Question 3	most classes are for adults
Question 4	meant for beginners
Question 5	we can attend any class for free
Question 6	friend
Question 7	She works in the morning.
Question 8	It's a great value for the money.

PART 3	
Question 1	A
Question 2	D
Question 3	E
Question 4	C
Question 5	D
Question 6	E
Question 7	B
Question 8	C
Question 9	E

PART 4	
Question 1	severance package
Question 2	backgrounds
Question 3	housing is affordable in their town.
Question 4	They took jobs at another manufacturing plant.
Question 5	The town is a pleasant place to settle down.
Question 6	the opportunity to work elsewhere
Question 7	pay income taxes
Question 8	severance
Question 9	accommodation costs
Question 10	Rousseau

Conteúdo licenciado para Arezoo -